



CITY COUNCIL MEETING MINUTES

October 22, 2024

CALL TO ORDER:

The Jackson City Council met in regular session in Council Chambers and was called to order at 6:30 p.m. by Mayor Daniel Mahoney.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE AND INVOCATION:

Council joined in the Pledge of Allegiance. Invocation was given by 6th Ward Councilmember Will Forgrave.

ROLL CALL:

Present: Mayor Daniel Mahoney, First Ward Councilmember Arlene Robinson, Vice Mayor/Second Ward Councilmember Freddie Dancy, Third Ward Councilmember Angelita Gunn, Fourth Ward Councilmember Conner Wood, Fifth Ward Councilmember Shalanda Hunt, and Sixth Ward Councilmember Will Forgrave.

Absent:

Also present: City Manager Jonathan Greene, City Attorney Matthew Hagerty, City Clerk Andrea Muray, Chief Equity Officer John Willis, Director of Police and Fire Services Elmer Hitt, Deputy Director of Fire Services Tim Gonzales, City Engineer Troy White, and Senior Appraiser Debi Koehn.

ADOPTION OF AGENDA:

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to adopt the agenda. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

PRESENTATIONS/PROCLAMATIONS: none.

PUBLIC HEARINGS:

A. Public Hearing of Necessity - Meterless Parking

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to conduct a public hearing to determine the necessity of the continuation of the meterless parking operation in downtown Jackson. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

Public comments were heard.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to close the public hearing. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

B. Public Hearing of Necessity- Construction on Pearl Street, Cooper Street to Waterloo Avenue

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Wood to open a public hearing of necessity for construction on Pearl Street, Cooper Street to Waterloo Avenue. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

City Engineer Troy White provided an overview of the proposed project.

No comments were offered during the hearing.

Motion was made by Councilmember Robinson, seconded by Councilmember Hunt to close the public hearing. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

CITIZEN COMMENTS:

Citizen comments were heard and the meeting continued.

CONSENT CALENDAR:

A. Minutes of the October 8, 2024 Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council

B. Special Event Application: Jackson Christmas Parade 2024

Approve a request from the Christmas Parade Committee to host the Downtown Jackson Christmas Parade on November 22, 2024, in downtown Jackson.

C. Special Event Calendar: Jack-O-Lantern Paws Parade Fest

Approve a request from Jack-Son Signature, LLC to host the Jack-O-Lantern Paws Parade Fest on October 26, 2024, in Horace Blackman Park and True Community Credit Union City Square.

D. Special Event Application: Jackson Turkey Trot 5k/10k Run/Walk

Approve a request from Tina & Jeff Beagle to host the Jackson Turkey Trot on November 22, 2024, in Ella Sharp Park.

E. Resolution - Delinquent Invoices

Approve the resolution placing delinquent invoices on the 2024 Winter Tax Bill

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to approve the consent calendar. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

OTHER BUSINESS:

A. East Side Economic Development Update

City Manager Jonathan Greene provided Council with an update on the East Side Economic Development Plan.

B. Second Reading/Final Adoption of Ordinance No. 2024-08 to Separate the Position of Director of Police and Fire Services into Two Positions

Recommendation: Approve the separating of the Director of Police and Fire Services into a Police and Fire Chief, as well as the applicable ordinance changes and move to second reading. In addition, authorize the City Manager to make the necessary administrative changes to the City's Personnel Policy and/or job classifications in accordance with the amendments.

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Hunt to approve the separating of the Director of Police and Fire Services into the Police and Fire Chief. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

C. Contract Award for Signal Shop Maintenance

Approve the award of the Signal Shop Maintenance contract to J. Ranck Electric, Inc. of Mount Pleasant, Michigan for a term of two calendar years with two possible two-year extensions and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate document(s) in accordance with the Purchasing Agent.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the award of the Signal Shop Maintenance contract to J. Ranck Electric, Inc. of Mount Pleasant, Michigan for a term of two calendar years with two possible two-year extensions and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate document(s). Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Gunn, Wood, and Hunt (5). Nays: Councilmembers Robinson and Forgrave (2). Motion carried.

NEW BUSINESS:

A. Resolution - Meterless Parking Necessity

Recommendation: *Approve the resolution determining the necessity for meterless parking in downtown Jackson as recommended by the Downtown Development Authority.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the resolution determining the necessity for meterless parking in downtown Jackson as recommended by the Downtown Development Authority. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, and Hunt (5). Nays: Vice Mayor Dancy and Councilmember Forgrave (2). Motion carried.

Motion was made by Mayor Mahoney, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy to have a study and RFP for metered parking. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

B. Resolution - Construction on Pearl Street, Cooper Street to Waterloo Avenue Necessity

Recommendation: Approve a resolution ordering construction on Pearl Street, Cooper Street to Waterloo Avenue

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Hunt to approve a resolution for construction on Pearl Street, Cooper Street to Waterloo Necessity. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, and Hunt (6). Nays: Councilmember Forgrave (1). Motion carried.

C. Budget Amendment and PSN Grant Award Acceptance

Recommendation: *Authorize Police & Fire Services Director Elmer Hitt to accept the FY 2024 PSN grant on behalf of the City, and amending the budget with the awarded funds as shown in the attached resolution.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to authorize Police & Fire Services Director Elmer Hitt to accept the FY 2024 PSN grant on behalf of the City. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

D. Downtown Jackson Social District Hours of Operation

Recommendation: *Approve the expansion of Downtown Jackson Social District hours of operation. From: Thursdays from 12 pm until 12 am; Fridays from 12 pm until 12 am, Saturdays from 9 am until 12 am, and Sundays from 9 am until 12 am, with additionally-approved special days during holidays, as designated by the Office of the City Manager, for the day before, the day of, and the day after those holidays. Furthermore, if any of those holidays fall on a Monday, Tuesday, or Wednesday, the hours will be consistent with the hours for Thursdays and Fridays of 12 pm until 12 am. To: Monday – Sunday 8:00 am -12:00am.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to approve the expansion of Downtown Jackson Social District hours of operation. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

E. City of Jackson Curb Appeal Program

Recommendation: *Authorize the creation of a City of Jackson Curb Appeal Program, approve the Program Guidelines and the creation of related application/administrative documents, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as needed.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Robinson, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to authorize the creation of a City of Jackson Curb Appeal Program and approve the program guidelines.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Hunt to postpone until the next meeting date. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

F. Change Order 1 to the Drinking Water State Revolving Fund (DWSRF) Phase 2 Water Main Replacements contract with Dunigan Brothers, Inc.

Recommendation: *Approve Change Order 1 to the Drinking Water State Revolving Fund (DWSRF) Phase 2 Water Main Replacements contract with Dunigan Brothers, Inc. to modify the contract to update federal boilerplate language to meet current requirements and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document. The contract amount remains unchanged by this Change Order.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to Change Order 1 to the Drinking Water State Revolving Fund (DWSRF) Phase 2 Water Main Replacements contract with Dunigan Brothers. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

G. Traffic Control Order 2404 - School Zone Speed Limit Signs – Argyle Street – Brown to Wisner

Recommendation: *Approval of Traffic Control Order 2404 to install School Zone Speed Limit signs reducing the speed limit to 25 miles per hour during the hours of 6:50 - 7:20 am and 2:10 – 2:50 pm on Argyle Street between Brown Street and Wisner Street.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Hunt to approve Traffic Control Order 2404 to install School Zone Speed Limit signs reducing the speed limit to 25 miles per hour during the hours of 6:50 -7:20 am and 2:10 – 2:50 pm on Argyle Street between Brown Street and Wisner Street. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

EXECUTIVE SESSION:

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to conduct closed session pursuant to MCL 15.268(d) to consider the purchase of real property. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to return to open session. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the purchase of 736 Page Avenue and all permits/licenses owned by the seller for the price on \$105,000 and for the City Attorney and City Manager to prepare and make minor modifications and sign documents to affect the purchase. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

CITY COUNCILMEMBER’S COMMENTS:

Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, and Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave offered comments.

MANAGER'S COMMENTS:

City Manager Jonathan Greene offered comments

ADJOURNMENT:

No further business being offered, a motion to adjourn was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Mayor Mahoney adjourned the meeting at 9:17 p.m.